

Most importantly, the state's dedication to the development of youth and ensuring employment is equally commendable. With a network of 65 employment offices, Haryana supports job-seekers and employers alike.

Under the 'Educated Youth Allowance and Honorarium Scheme', launched in 2016, ₹1,779 crore in unemployment allowances and ₹956.03 crore in honorariums have been disbursed to eligible youths. Since its inception, 430,070 applications have been approved, showcasing the state's commitment to providing meaningful employment opportunities to the youth. From organizing 2,083 job fairs to setting up Model Career Centers under the National Career Service project, Haryana has ensured that its youth are equipped to meet the demands of the job market.

TRANSFORMATIVE HEALTHCARE THROUGH CHIRAYU AYUSHMAN AND SOCIAL SECURITY PENSIONS

The Haryana Government has made remarkable strides in enhancing the wellbeing of its citizens through a series of impactful healthcare and social security initiatives. Among these, the Chirayu and Ayushman programs have brought comprehensive healthcare benefits to millions. The journey towards better healthcare began with a substantial increase in per capita health expenditure which rose from ₹1,043 in 2014-15 to ₹2,549.54 in 2023-24.

This financial commitment has been matched by an expanded healthcare network encompassing 72 civil hospitals, 123 community health centers, 409 primary health centers and 2,734 sub-health centers. The infrastructure growth is evident in the construction of 194 new healthcare buildings since 2014, including 48 sub-health centers, 60 primary health centers, 36 community health centers, and 27 civil hospitals.

In response to the COVID-19 pandemic, the state also built two temporary 500-bed hospitals in 2021-22. Significant upgrading of the existing facilities has bolstered the healthcare system, with 13 civil hospitals increasing their bed capacities and the Ambala City hospital expanding from 200 to 300 beds. Specialized centers such as the Atal Cancer Care Center and maternal and child health centers coming up in various districts demonstrate Haryana's commitment to targeted medical care.

The state's proactive approach to healthcare is further reflected in its 580 ambulances and 59 mobile medical units, which ensure that medical services reach even the remotest parts of the state. In the realm of free medication, Haryana offers a vast range of essential drugs at no cost, including 547 medicines, 256 consumables, 53 COVID-19 items, and 88 dental items.

The 'Mukhyamantri Muft Ilaaj Yojana', introduced in January 2014, guarantees free services across seven categories, from surgeries to dental treatment. The Comprehensive Cashless Health Facility (CCHF) extends cashless medical reimbursements to government employees, pensioners, and their dependents, enhancing accessibility to healthcare.

The Ayushman Bharat-Pradhan Mantri Jan Arogya Yojana (PMJAY), launched on September 23, 2018, offers annual health coverage of up to ₹5 lakh per family. So far, 1.19 crore Ayushman cards have been issued, covering 15.54 lakh families. Under the Chirayu Yojana which targets Antyodaya families with incomes below ₹1.8 lakh, 87.49 lakh Ayushman cards have been issued. The scheme has since been expanded to families with incomes between ₹1.8 lakh and ₹3 lakh.

In terms of social security and pensions, Haryana has pioneered transfer of 100% of social security pensions via DBT since August, 2020. The number of beneficiaries under the Old Age Samman Allowance Scheme, linked with Family Identification Certificate, has gone up to 19.93 Lakhs people. Similarly, benefit of the Disability Pension Scheme has reached 1.98 lakh disabled persons,